

Diverse Airliners

The age of cooperation between European manufacturers and governments dawned, along with bounding optimism for the future of high-speed air travel. It gave life to some of the most successful airliners ever—the vast Boeing 747 “Jumbo Jet,” the wide-body A300 Airbus—and some of the most spectacular: the Concorde. But there were also some expensive, and embarrassing, sales flops.



△ **VFW-Fokker 614 1971**
Origin Germany
Engine 2 x 7,473 lb (3,385 kg) thrust
Rolls-Royce/Snecma M45H Mk501 turbofan
Top speed 437 mph (703 km/h)

German-government backed and designed for small regional airlines, the 614's engines were mounted on pylons above the wings. Slow development made it expensive and only 16 were built.



▽ **Boeing 747 “Classic” 1970**
Origin US
Engine 4 x 54,750 lb (24,802 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney JT9D-7R4G2 turbofan
Top speed 594 mph (955 km/h)

The world's first wide-body double-deck airliner, the “Jumbo Jet” had the highest passenger capacity for 37 years. It was a very successful and fast subsonic airliner, with more than 1,435 built so far.



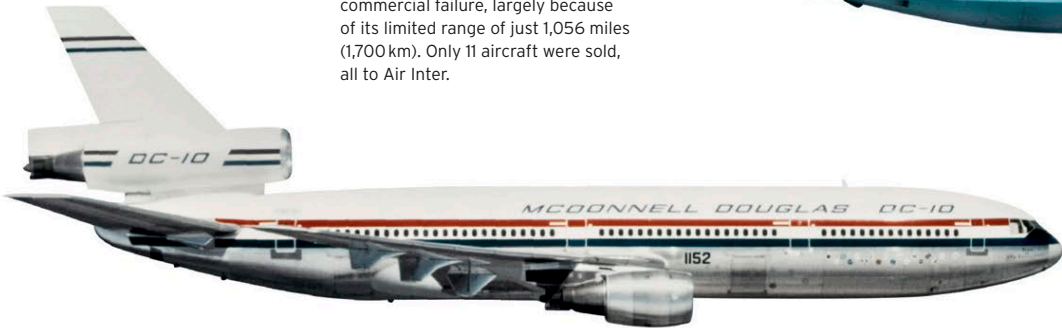
▽ **Fokker F28-4000 Fellowship 1976**
Origin Netherlands/Germany/N. Ireland
Engine 2 x 9,900 lb (4,485 kg) thrust
Rolls-Royce RB183-2 “Spey” Mk555-15P turbofan
Top speed 523 mph (843 km/h)

A short-range jet airliner designed jointly in the 1960s by Dutch, German, and Northern Irish companies and first flown in 1967, the stretched F28-4000 of 1976 proved most successful.



▷ **Dassault Mercure 1971**
Origin France
Engine 2 x 15,500 lb (7,022 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney JT8D-15 turbofan
Top speed 578 mph (930 km/h)

A larger, faster rival to the Boeing 737 and Douglas DC-9, this was a commercial failure, largely because of its limited range of just 1,056 miles (1,700 km). Only 11 aircraft were sold, all to Air Inter.



◁ **McDonnell Douglas DC-10 1970**
Origin US
Engine 3 x 41,500 lb (18,800 kg) thrust
General Electric CF6-6 turbofan
Top speed 610 mph (982 km/h)

Launched in medium-range (domestic US) form and joined in 1972 by long-range variants, this wide-body airliner had a long, successful service, carrying passengers, cargo, fuel, or water.

▷ **McDonnell Douglas DC-9 1979**
Origin US
Engine 2 x 18,500 lb (8,381 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney JT8D-200 series
Top speed 575 mph (925 km/h)

Based on a 1960s design, the DC-9 was a midsize, medium-range airliner, highly successful thanks to features such as smaller wings and higher-bypass engines; 1,191 were built.

